Tempting though it may be to disregard Ashton's text as politically insignificant, she was no political outlier and her statement was far from trivial and unrehearsed. As the EU's premier foreign policy chief, Ashton was a privileged political player whose manipulation of "human rights" discourse was pedestrian and in keeping with other EU statements. With antisemitism nearly impossible to justify on its own, its vindication relies on the epoch's highest cultural authorities.[3] That contemporary antisemitism employs the language and institutions of "human rights" should, thus, come as no surprise.

Years earlier, in 2011, the European Union's Fundamental Rights Agency (FRA) issued a brochure that was—like Ashton's statement—similarly averse to identifying antisemitism as the cause of the Holocaust. In *Human rights education at Holocaust memorial sites across the European Union*,[4] the Agency worries that "*most of the memorial sites. . .do not systematically include education on human rights in their work.*"[5] With the most lethal manifestation of antisemitism excluded from the rubric of "human rights," the Agency then employed the genocide against Jews as a backdrop to foreground the fundamental rights and violations of others.

That the FRA's distribution of this 2011 brochure at the 4th International Conference of the Global Forum for Combatting Antisemitism (28–30 May 2013), occasioned no public outcry may mean that few people bothered to read it carefully. Perhaps its professed subject rendered the brochure innocuous. Or, met with repeated accusations of Jewish particularism and exclusivity, perhaps many Jews have grown accustomed to the removal of Jewish specificity from accounts of, and references to, the Holocaust. Then again, maybe antisemitism's pervasiveness numbs our outrage.

There were, to be sure, countless matters that clamored for the attention of conference delegates and chief among them was the FRA's release of its initial findings from its 2013 survey on antisemitism. These data provided an ominous glimpse into the then-current conditions and the future for Jews throughout Europe. In addition to enduring antisemitic harassment and discrimination (26 percent of Jewish respondents claim to have experienced antisemitic harassment at least once in the twelve months preceding the survey), between 40 and 50 percent of respondents from three of the eight Member States (Belgium, France, and Hungary) stated they had considered emigrating from their country of residence because they did not feel safe.[6] Such fears were hardly ill-founded. Within a year of the report's release, a French citizen with ISIS (Islamic State of Iraq and Syria) affiliations murdered four people in the Jewish Museum in Brussels—the capital of the European Union.

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